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# Magistrate Wizard workflows — plain language

How magistrates, clerks, and administrators actually use the system. Written for a first-day colleague, not for the database.

Magistrate Wizard

Architecture as implemented (migrations 0001–0067)

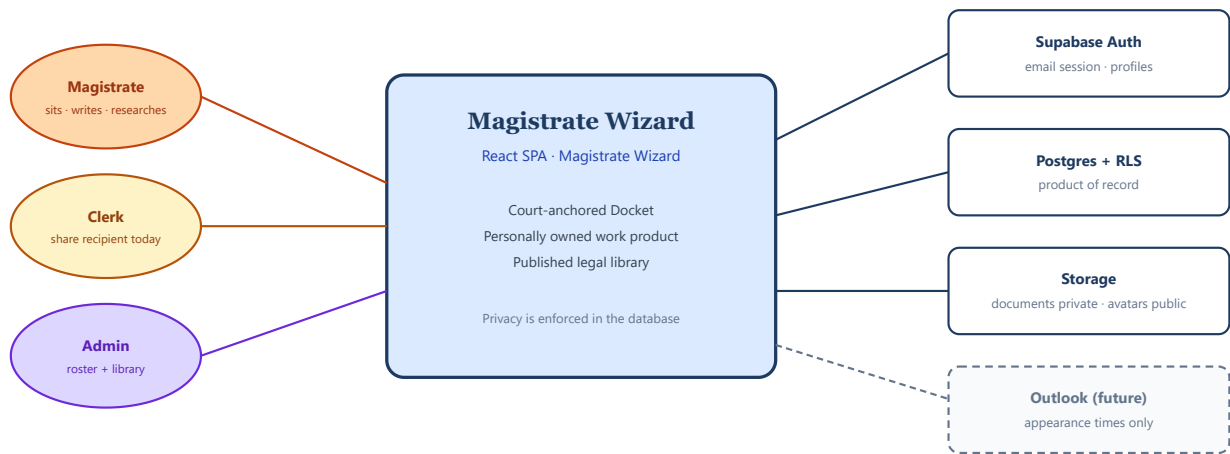
Court-anchored Docket · no admin bypass into private judicial content

13 August 2026

# Hero diagrams

## System context

Magistrate Wizard is one web app. Supabase is the only backend. Outlook is future.

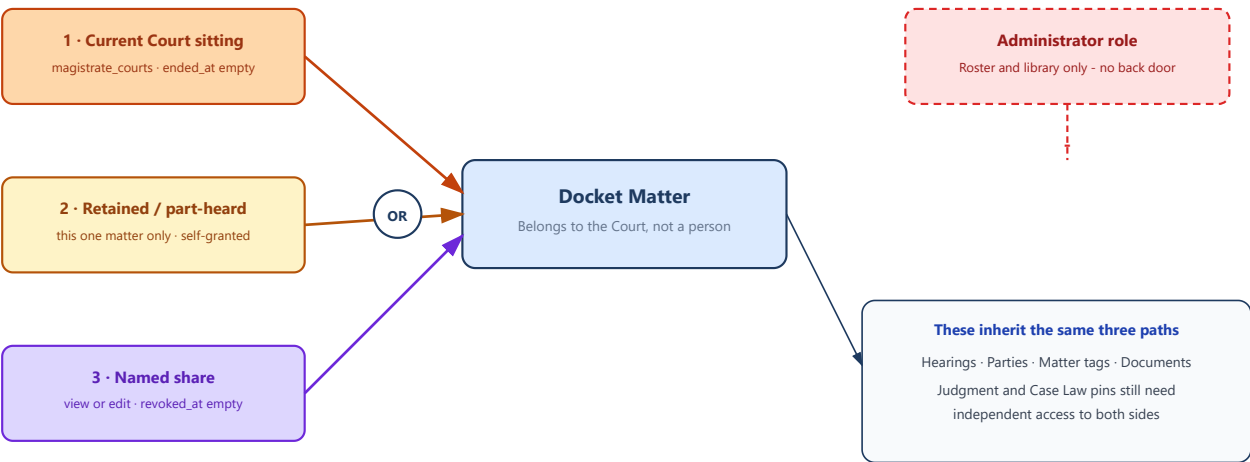


No Edge Functions in production today. Search and ingestion RPCs run inside Postgres.

System context — people, the app, and Supabase

## How someone opens a Docket Matter

Three lawful paths. Any one is enough. Administrator is not a fourth path.

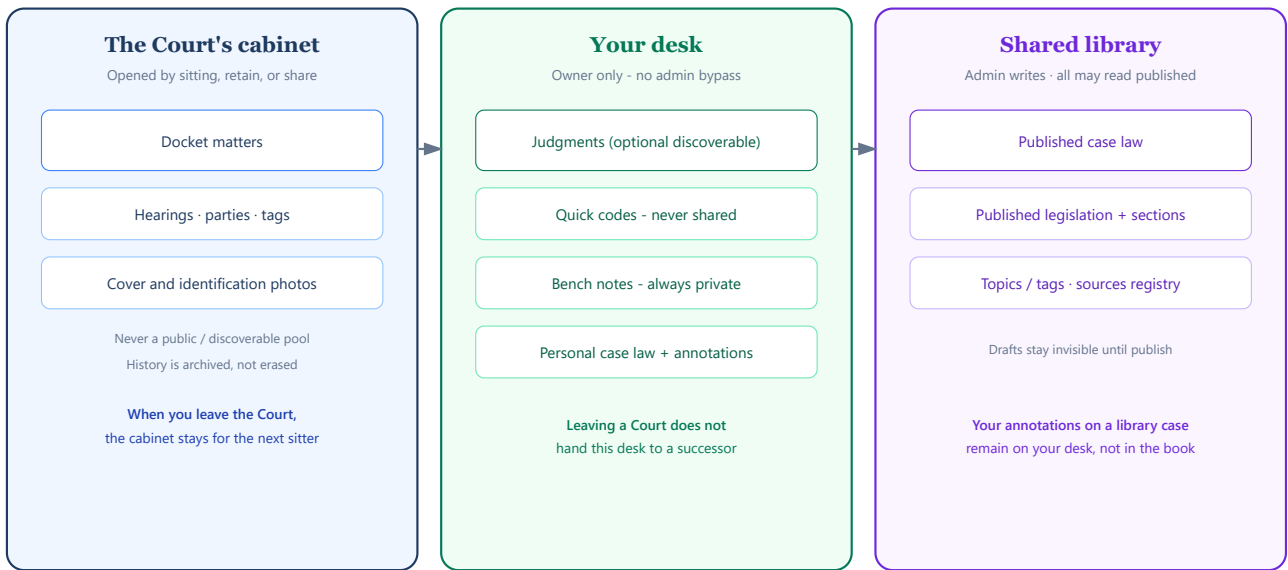


Magistrate Wizard · Court-Anchored Docket · can\_access\_court OR has\_retained\_assignment OR has\_docket\_share

Three paths onto a Docket Matter

## Three cabinets, three lock types

A pin between cabinets never copies the keys.

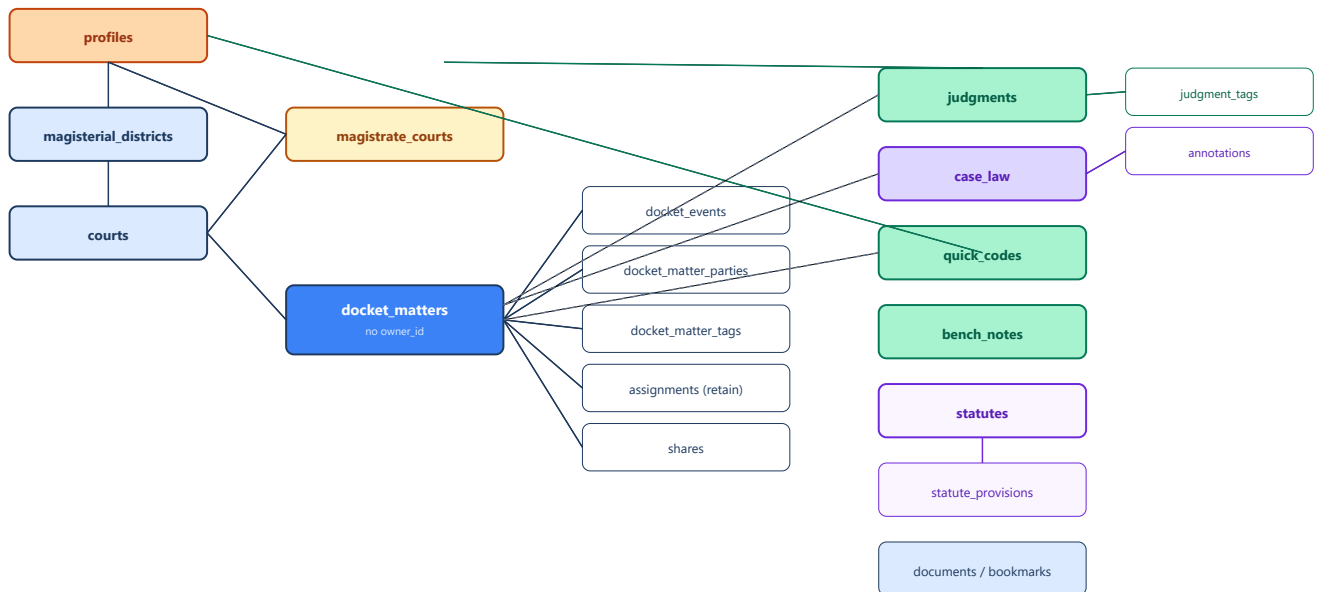


Dashed idea: a link is a pin, not a key · BOTH sides must already be readable

## Court cabinet, personal desk, shared library

### Entity map - who relates to whom

Boxes are tables. Crow's-feet mean "many". Dashed lines are association-only (a pin, not a key).



**Solid line** parent / child or ownership

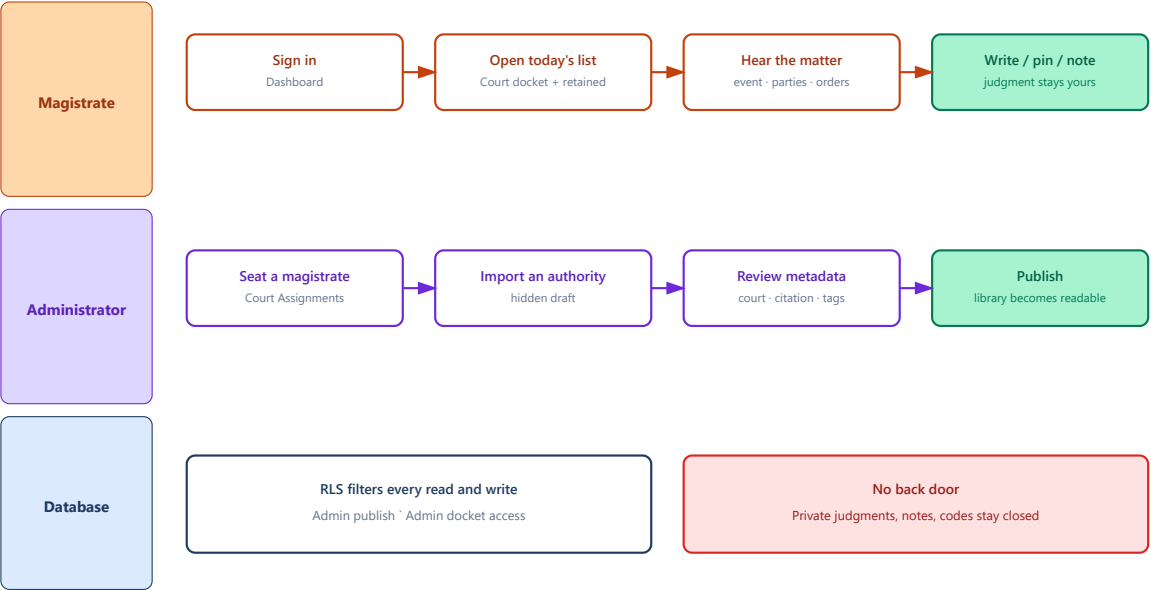
**Dashed line** association table - BOTH sides already readable, never confers access

Legacy cases / case\_parties omitted - unused by new development. legal\_authority\_courts is a separate "reported court" list, not courts.

## Entity map

# A sitting day vs an admin day

Left to right in time. Same product, different keys.



A sitting day versus an admin day

## o. How to read these guides

### What Magistrate Wizard is

Magistrate Wizard is a computer filing system for magistrates. It holds:

- the **Court's docket** (the list of matters before that Court)
- **your** written work (judgments, research notes, shortcuts)
- a **shared law library** (published case law and legislation)

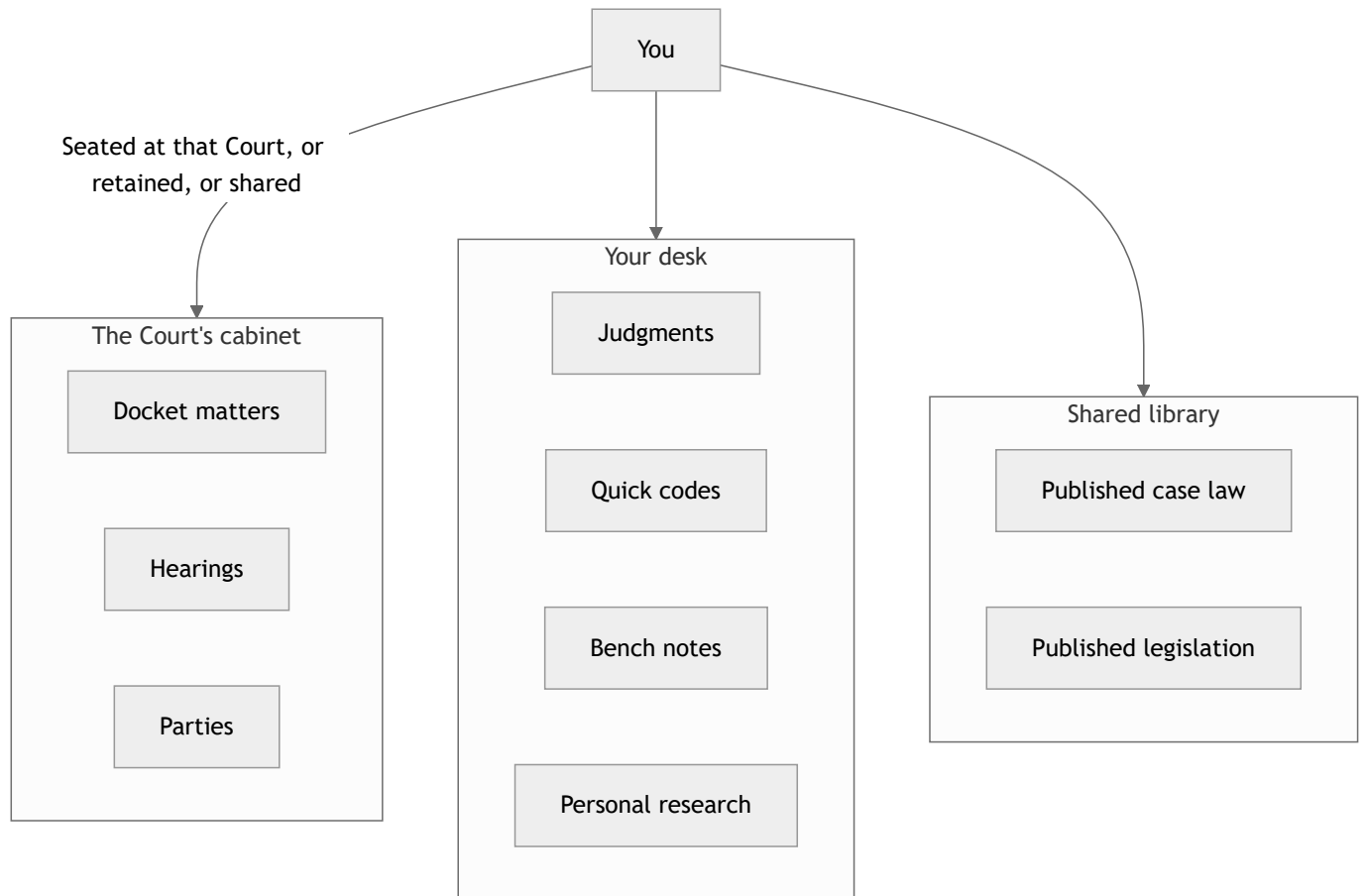
It is not a public website. Members of the public cannot browse it. Every screen you open has already been filtered so you only see what you are allowed to see.

### Words used here

| Word                         | Everyday meaning in Magistrate Wizard                                                                                                          |
|------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Court</b>                 | A physical Guyana Magistrates' Court (for example, a sitting at a named location). Not the Caribbean Court of Justice as a reported authority. |
| <b>District</b>              | The Magisterial District that Court belongs to. Case numbers are unique <i>inside a district</i> , not nationwide.                             |
| <b>Docket matter</b>         | One case file on that Court's list. Arraignment, maintenance, traffic — all are "matters".                                                     |
| <b>Event</b>                 | One listed appearance or hearing date for that matter.                                                                                         |
| <b>Retained / part-heard</b> | You kept access to <b>one</b> matter after you stopped sitting that Court, so you can finish it.                                               |
| <b>Share</b>                 | You let a <i>named colleague</i> see one matter. Exceptional, not the normal way work moves on.                                                |
| <b>Canonical case law</b>    | An entry in the official library, published by an administrator. Everyone signed in can read it.                                               |
| <b>Personal case law</b>     | Your own research card. Private unless you mark it discoverable.                                                                               |
| <b>Discoverable</b>          | Others may <i>read</i> . They still cannot edit. Used for judgments and personal case law — <b>never</b> for the docket.                       |
| <b>Admin</b>                 | Someone who seats magistrates at Courts and publishes the library. Admin is <b>not</b> a master key to other people's private writing.         |

### A picture of the locks

[!Three cabinets, three lock types](#)



## What these guides are not

They are not the architecture specification. They do not replace training on the law. They describe **how the software behaves today**.

# 1. Getting started

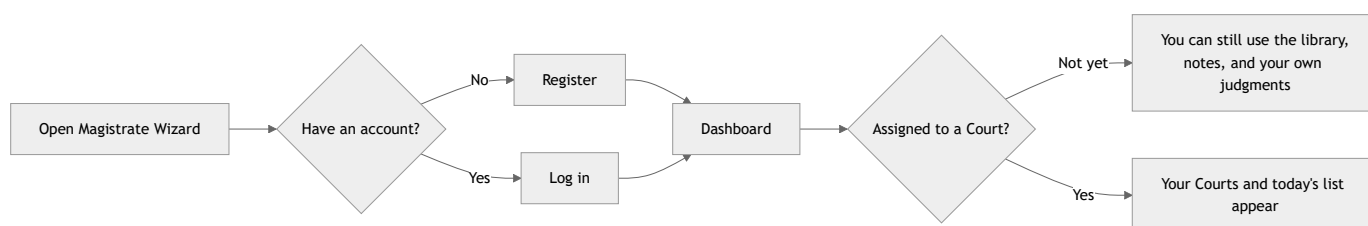
**Who:** anyone with a Magistrate Wizard account

**Goal:** sign in and understand the home screen

**Time:** a few minutes

## Steps

1. Open Magistrate Wizard in a browser.
2. If you have no account, use **Register**. You will get a profile. You will **not** yet have a Court.
3. If you forgot the password, use **Forgot password**.
4. After login you land on the **Dashboard**.



## What you will see on the Dashboard

The Dashboard only summarises things you could already open elsewhere. It never shows another Court's secret list.

Typical rows:

- **Your current Courts** — where you are seated right now
- **Upcoming appearances** — hearing dates still marked scheduled
- **Active matters** — docket files in progress
- **Retained / part-heard** — matters you kept after leaving a Court
- **Your draft and final judgments**
- **Your quick codes and bench notes**

## Common surprises

| You expected                                    | What actually happens                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "I registered, so I should see a docket."       | Registration only creates <i>you</i> . An administrator must seat you at a Court.                                                               |
| "I am an administrator, so I see every docket." | No. Admin tools manage the <i>roster</i> and the <i>library</i> . To work a docket you still need a real Court assignment, like any magistrate. |
| "Search will find everything in the system."    | Search only returns what you are already allowed to open.                                                                                       |

## If something goes wrong

- Wrong password → Forgot password.
- Logged in but sent to **Unauthorized** → you opened an admin page without the admin role.
- Dashboard looks empty → you may be unassigned. You can still open Case Law, Legislation, Judgments, Quick Codes, Bench Notes, Bookmarks, and Search.



## 2. Court assignment

**Who:** administrator seats; magistrate is seated

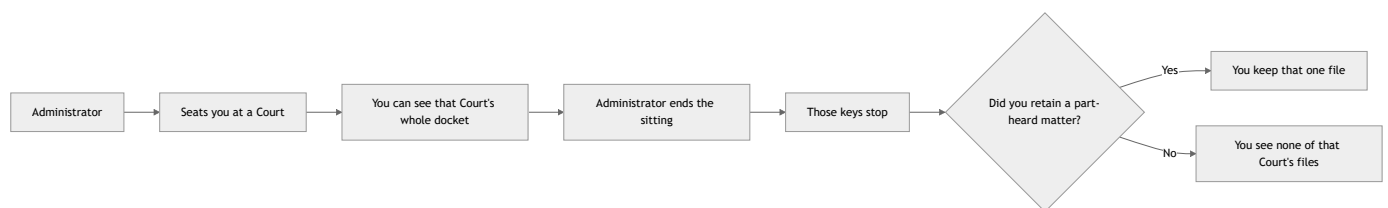
**Goal:** open the Court's docket for a person

**Everyday analogy:** handing someone the keys to a particular courtroom's filing cabinet

### Why this exists

A docket is **not** "Magistrate X's cases". It is **that Court's cases**. The software therefore asks: *who is currently sitting this Court?*

That answer lives in a dated assignment. While the end date is empty, you have the keys. When an administrator fills the end date, those keys stop working.



### What the administrator does

1. Open **Court Assignments** (admin menu).
2. Choose the magistrate's profile.
3. Choose an **active** Court.
4. Create the assignment.

To move someone to another Court: **end** the current assignment, then create a new one. Do not pretend the old row was always the new Court — history is kept.

To offboard someone: end their Court sittings (and make sure part-heard retains are ended too). Prefer **deactivating** the account later. Do not delete the person if they created docket files — the system needs to remember who did the work.

### What the magistrate cannot do

You cannot seat yourself. You cannot end your own Court sitting. That is deliberate. Anyone who could seat themselves could open any Court's cabinet.

### Assignment types

Regular, acting, relief, or other. They are labels for the roster. **They do not change permissions.** Any current sitting, of any type, opens that Court's docket the same way.

## Dual access is normal

Suppose you retained matter 45 from a Court you left. A new magistrate is now seated there. **Both of you can open matter 45.** You are not the owner. You are finishing a hearing. They are running the Court.

## Related guide

When you are about to leave, read [Sharing and retained matters](#) *before* the administrator ends your sitting. You can only retain a matter while you still have the Court keys.

## 3. Working a docket matter

**Who:** a magistrate (or clerk) who can already open that Court's list

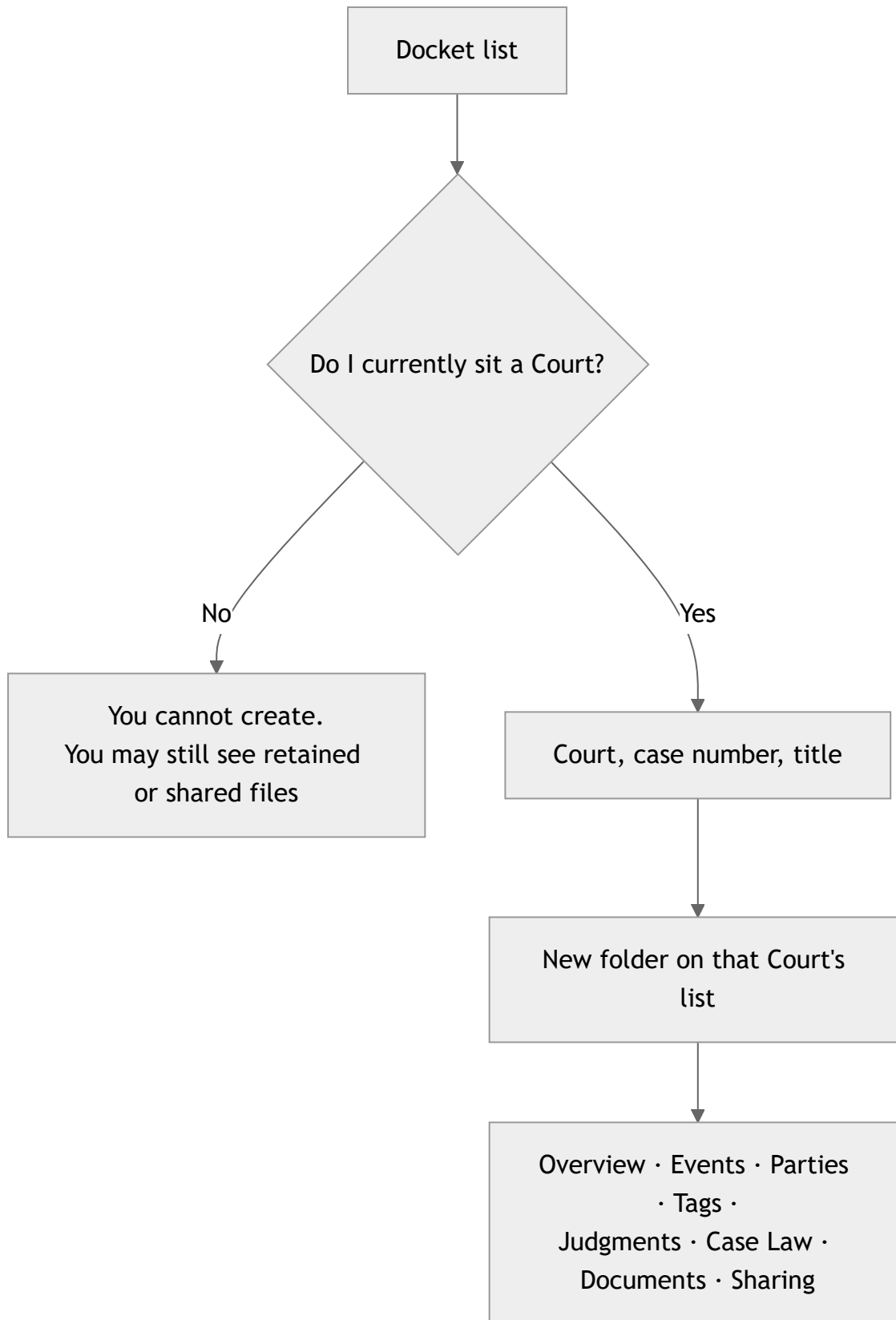
**Goal:** create and run one case file

**Everyday analogy:** opening a new folder in the Court's cabinet, not in your briefcase

### Create a matter

1. Go to **Docket**.
2. Start a new matter.
3. Pick a Court you **currently sit**.
4. Enter the official **case number** and a short **title** (the names you would read out).
5. Save.

The district is filled in from the Court. You do not choose it. Case numbers must be unique **inside that district**, not worldwide — two districts may both have "45/2024".



## The matter page

| Tab       | What it is for                                                                |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Overview  | Charge or issue, rolling orders, overall outcome, status, cover image, retain |
| Events    | Each listed date                                                              |
| Parties   | People and roles, optional identification photo                               |
| Tags      | Court-visible labels such as "urgent" (not your private sticky notes)         |
| Judgments | Pin <i>your</i> written rulings to this file                                  |
| Case Law  | Pin authorities you can read                                                  |
| Documents | PDFs and other attachments                                                    |
| Sharing   | Let one named colleague in                                                    |

You can bookmark the matter from the header.

## Status

- **Active** — live
- **Stayed** — paused; a retained magistrate still keeps it
- **Completed** — finished; any retain ends automatically
- **Archived** — filed away; retain also ends

There is no "delete this case from history" button. That is the point of a court record.

## Cover image

A cover photo (often a party's identification picture reused) appears on tiles and the top of the page. It is stored as a private file. Anyone who can already open the matter can see it.

## If create is blocked

You are not currently assigned to the Court you picked. Ask an administrator to seat you, or work from a matter that was retained or shared with you.

## What this file is not

It is not your personal notebook. Colleagues who later sit the same Court will see it. Put private thinking in **Bench Notes** or **personal Case Law**, not in the matter's institutional tags.

## 4. Hearings, parties, and documents

**Who:** anyone with edit access to the matter (Court sitting, retain, or an **edit** share)

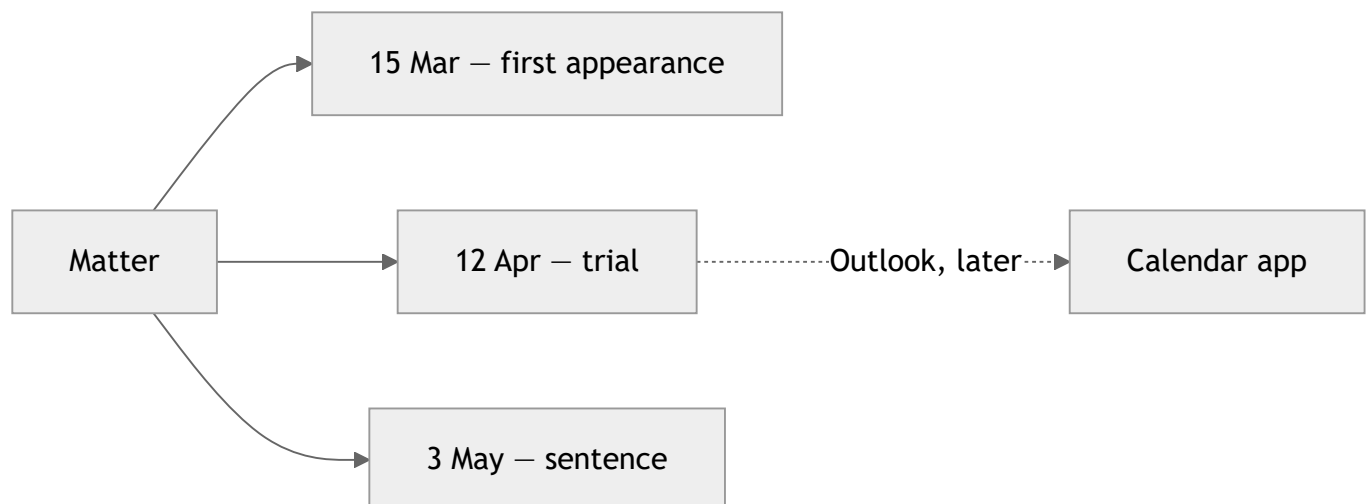
**Goal:** record who appeared, when they must return, and what was filed

### Hearings (Events)

A matter lasts. Hearings stack up: first appearance, adjournment, trial, review.

1. Open the matter → **Events**.
2. Add an event.
3. **Date is required.** Time may wait until the list is settled.
4. Optionally note type, stage, what was ordered *that day*, and free notes.

"Next appearance" is not a separate field. The system looks at the dated events. If you reschedule, change the event — do not keep a stale "next date" on the folder cover.



Outlook, when it arrives, may copy **dates**. It will not be allowed to rewrite the charge or the orders.

The name of who presided is recorded as history. It is not a permission. Sitting the Court is what grants permission.

### Parties

1. Open **Parties**.
2. Add a name, a **party type**, and a **role** (they are different vocabularies — type is who they are in the proceeding; role is the part they play).
3. Names are not unique. Two "John Singh" rows are allowed; people are not identifiers.
4. Do not "delete" a party to rewrite history. Status is used instead.
5. You may attach an **identification photograph**. It can be shown on the party list and reused as the matter cover.

Contact details stay in the form — they are not splashed on the list the way a photo may be.

## Documents

Attachments follow the **folder they hang on**:

- On a matter → anyone with that matter
- On your judgment → you (and readers if you made it discoverable)
- On library case law → follows whether that entry is published / yours / discoverable

Upload PDFs, images, Word, Markdown, or text files into the private documents store. The app then shows a time-limited view. There is no public download page.

Identification photos and covers are documents too, marked so they do not clutter the ordinary attachments list.

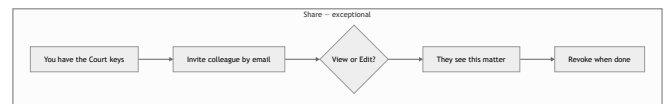
## Tags on a matter

Matter tags are **institutional**. The next magistrate at that Court will see "urgent". They are not your private "read on Friday" label. Private labels are a future feature and must not piggy-back on these tags.

## 5. Sharing and retained matters

Two different kindnesses. Do not mix them up.

|               | Share                                                           | Retain (part-heard)                                                            |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When          | A colleague needs this <i>one</i> file for a short consultation | You are leaving the Court but this matter is still yours to finish             |
| Who grants it | Anyone who already has Court or retained access                 | Only <b>you</b> , and only <b>for yourself</b> , while you still sit the Court |
| How wide      | One named person                                                | One named person — you                                                         |
| How it ends   | Revoke, or they give it back                                    | You end it, or completing/archiving the matter ends it                         |
| Typical story | "Please look at this maintenance file with me."                 | "I started the trial; I will finish it after I move."                          |



### How to share

1. Open the matter → **Sharing**.
2. Enter the colleague's **exact account email**.
3. Choose **view** (read) or **edit** (they may update the file the way a sitting magistrate would, with the limits described below).
4. They cannot pass the share on.
5. To change view into edit: revoke, then share again. The old row stays as history.

If the page says you cannot share, you only have a *view* share yourself, or you no longer have Court/retained authority.

**View** lets them read the matter, events, parties, and tags. It does not let them pin a Judgment or Case Law card. **Edit** lets them change the file, but still does not open a Judgment they do not own, and still cannot pin Judgment or Case Law (that needs Court or retained keys).

The Sharing screen may still *show* Save buttons to a view-only colleague. If they try, the save fails. The lock is in the database, not a greyed-out form.

### How to retain

1. While you **still sit** the Court, open Overview.
2. Choose **Retain this matter**.
3. You cannot retain a file for someone else. You cannot retain a file at a Court you do not currently sit.



After your sitting ends, the matter stays on your Dashboard under **Retained / Part-Heard**. When the matter is completed or archived, the retain ends by itself. A stay does **not** end it — a paused trial may resume in your hands.

## Offboarding

Before a magistrate leaves office:

1. They retain any part-heard files *first*.
2. Administrator ends Court sittings.
3. Remaining live retains are ended when the work is truly handed on.
4. Keep the person's name in the system. Deleting the profile is an emergency, not a retirement party.

## Related

Court keys: [Court assignment](#).

## 6. Writing a judgment

**Who:** you, the author

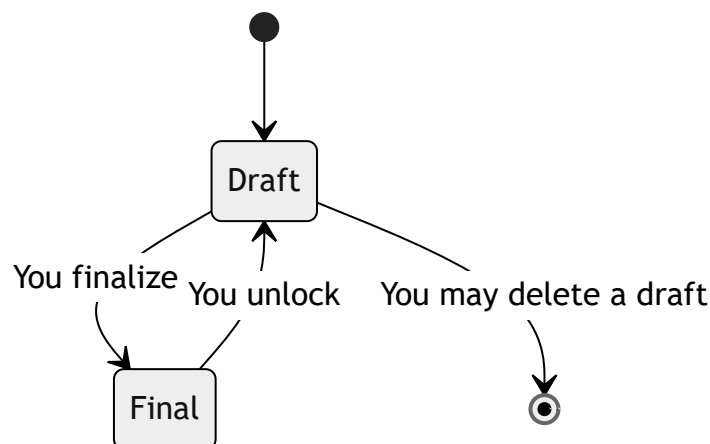
**Goal:** draft, lock, and optionally let colleagues read

**Everyday analogy:** the opinion is in *your* bound volume. The docket folder may point to it. Pointing is not photocopying.

### Create

1. Open **Judgments**.
2. Create a new one. It always starts as **draft** and always belongs to you. You cannot create one in a colleague's name.

Fill title, optional case number, court name (plain words — it does not have to be a Court on the roster), date, citation, and the text.



### Finalize

Finalizing **locks the words**: title, numbers, dates, citation, body. You can still:

- toggle **discoverable**
- add tags
- attach files

Pin the judgment onto a matter from the matter's **Judgments** tab (not from this page). Quick Code associations are not editable in the screens yet.

You cannot delete a final judgment until you unlock it back to draft. Unlock first, edit in a **separate** save. The system will refuse a single save that both unlocks and rewrites the text — that would be a back door.

### Discoverable

Off (default): only you.

On: every signed-in magistrate may **read**. They still cannot edit, delete, or take it over.

This is *not* making it canonical case law. It is not publishing to the world. It is "colleagues may look this up".

## Link to a docket matter

From the matter's **Judgments** tab, pin a judgment **you own**. Being able to read a colleague's discoverable judgment is not enough to pin it.

A magistrate who later sits that Court will see the matter. They will **not** automatically see your private judgment. The pin does not hand them the volume.

## Leaving a Court

Your judgments stay yours. The new magistrate gets the docket, not your prose.

## Administrator

Admin cannot open your private judgment. There is no "break glass" button for judicial writing.

# 7. Researching case law

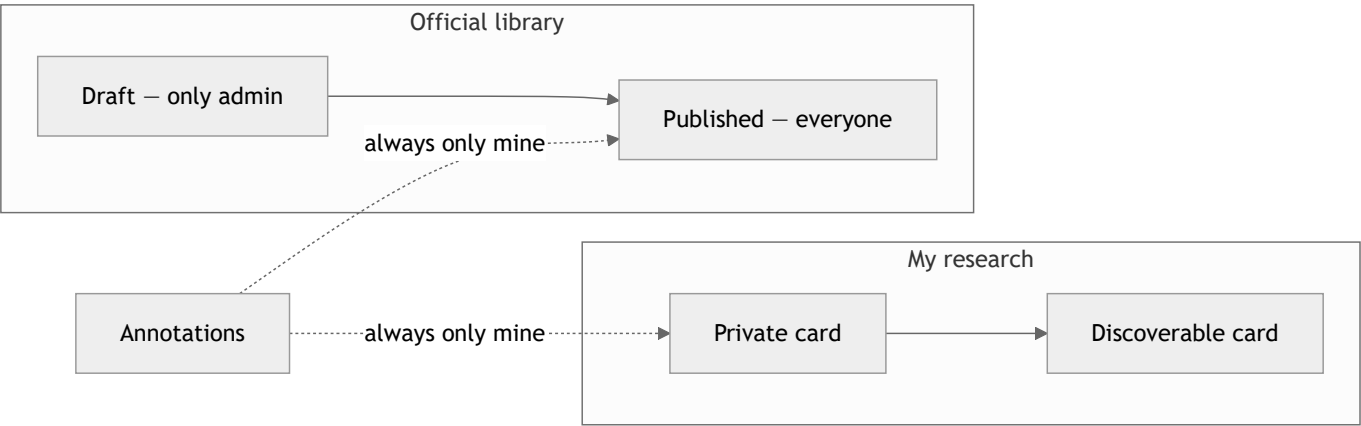
**Who:** every signed-in user for the published library; you for your private cards

**Goal:** find authorities, keep personal notes, pin them onto a matter

## Two kinds of card, one list

| Kind                | Who writes it               | Who reads it                         |
|---------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Library (canonical) | Administrator, after review | Everyone, once <b>published</b>      |
| Personal            | You                         | You, unless you mark it discoverable |

They live in the same **Case Law** area so a search can return both. They are not two different apps.



## Browse published law

Open **Case Law**. Use the canonical tab. You may filter by jurisdiction and deciding court (the *reported* court — CCJ, a High Court, and so on — not the Magistrates' Court you sit).

Unpublished imports never appear here. That is how the library stays clean.

## Your own cards

Create a personal entry for a decision you are studying. Citation need not be unique — two magistrates may both note the same case.

Mark discoverable only if you want colleagues to read the card. They still will not see your **annotations**.

## Annotations

Pin a passage and a note. Multiple notes per case are fine. The person who owns the library entry (even an admin) cannot see *your* notes on it. If the parent card later becomes unreadable to you, your notes hide until you can read the parent again. They are not deleted.

## Pin onto a docket matter

Open the Case Law card → **Link to a Docket Matter**. Pick a matter you sit or have retained. A share-only copy of a file is not enough to create the pin — the save will fail.

The matter's **Case Law** tab is a reverse view of pins already made. You do not create the link from there.

You do **not** need to “own” a library case to cite it — citing is what the library is for. Citing does not grant the next magistrate your private annotations.

## What is not here yet

Sharing a personal card with one named colleague (the way docket shares work) is not built. Outlook does not ingest authorities. The library is not a web crawler — see the admin guide.

## 8. Legislation, bench notes, and quick codes

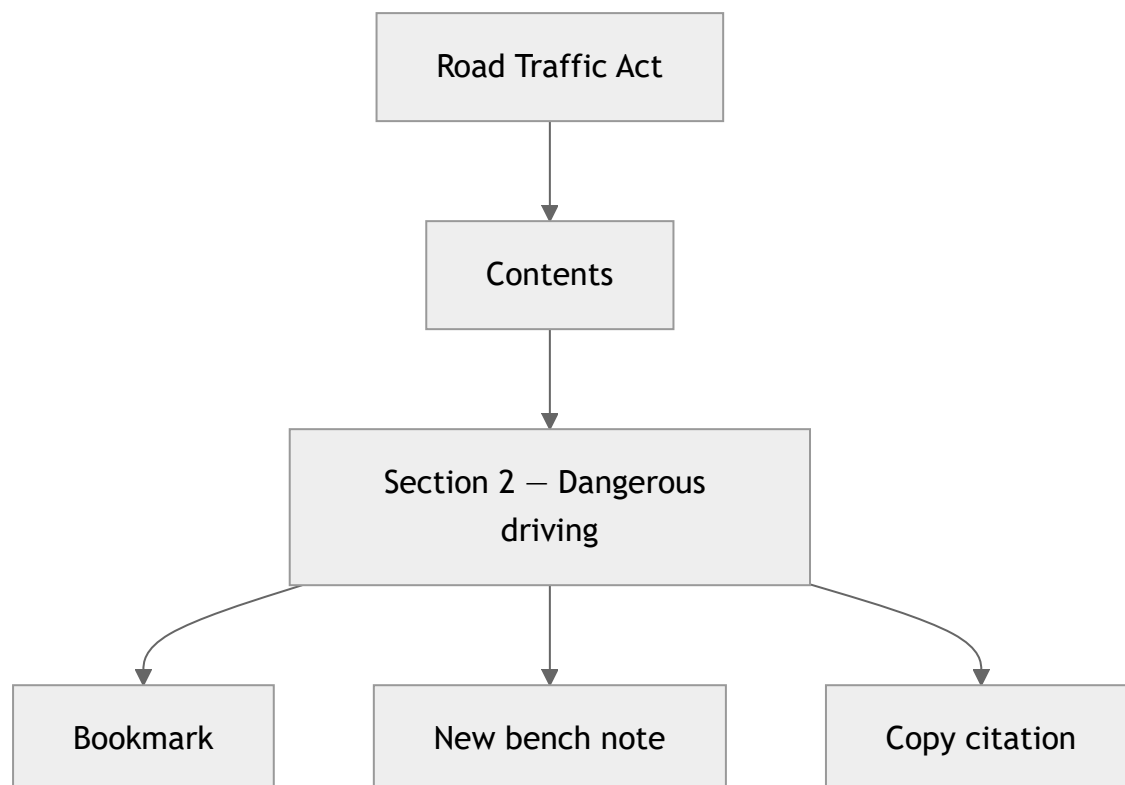
### Legislation

**Legislation** is the published statute book.

1. Open the list. Only **published** Acts appear.
2. Open an Act. If it has been broken into parts and sections, you get a table of contents and a reader.
3. A section has a stable link ( `/legislation/.../section/...` ). Bookmark that section, copy its text, copy a short citation, or start a **bench note** locked to that section.

If an Act has no structured sections yet, you see the older whole-text view. Nothing is broken.

Draft Acts in the admin import queue are invisible here, same rule as unpublished case law.



### Bench notes

A bench note is a **private working note**. Only you see it, even if it is "about" a docket matter or a statute section everyone can read.

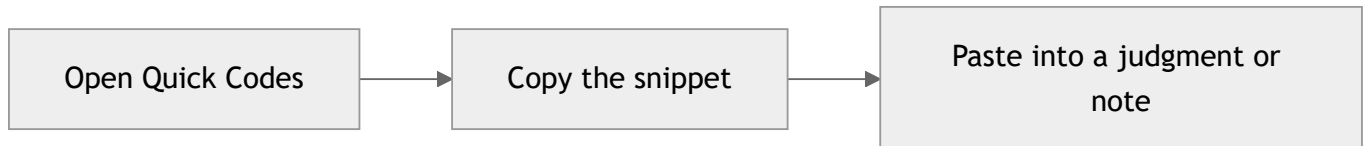
Create from **Bench Notes** (pick a parent: matter, judgment, case law, or Act), or from a legislation **section** (the parent is then locked to that section). There is no "New Bench Note" button on a docket, judgment, or case-law page today.

This is the right place for "ask clerk about service" — not the Court's institutional matter tag.

## Quick codes

Quick codes are **your** text shortcuts. Example: a standard adjournment formula stored under a short code word.

- Unique per person. Two magistrates may both use `adj`.
- Nobody else can see them. Not the administrator. Not a colleague you shared a docket with.
- **Copy** puts the snippet on the clipboard. There is no in-editor "type `adj` and it expands" yet.
- Existing links to matters, judgments, or case law can be *viewed*. Creating or removing those links is not in the screens yet.



## Bookmarks vs notes vs codes

| Tool       | Purpose                                  |
|------------|------------------------------------------|
| Bookmark   | "I want to find this again."             |
| Bench note | "I want to write about this, privately." |
| Quick code | "I want to reuse a paragraph of my own." |

## 9. Admin: roster and library

**Who:** users with the administrator role

**Goal:** seat magistrates, and publish clean law into the shared library

**What this is not:** a window into other magistrates' private judgments, notes, or snippets

### Court Assignments

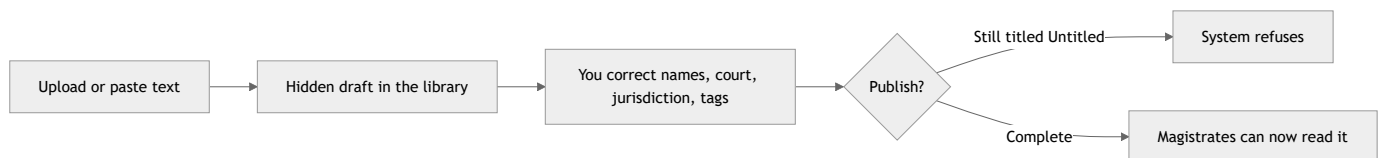
Covered in [Court assignment](#). Recap:

- Only admin can create or end a sitting.
- Ending a sitting does not delete the Court's files.
- Admin still needs their *own* sitting to work a docket.

### Legal Library workspace

Open **Legal Library**. Typical tabs:

1. **Sources** — a register of places law *might* come from. Saving a source does **not** download anything. There is no crawler yet.
2. **New Import** — one document at a time.
3. **Review Queue** — drafts waiting for a human.
4. **Batches** — bulk import history. Every file should leave a trail, including duplicates.





## Honest limits (do not over-claim to users)

| Feature                                | Today                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>.txt</code> / Markdown auto-read | Yes                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| PDF / Word text                        | Text-layer PDFs extracted automatically; scanned PDFs and images recognized locally; <code>.docx</code> extracted in the browser. Word 97–2003 ( <code>.doc</code> ) still needs paste or a <code>.docx</code> copy |
| Fetch from a URL                       | Not built                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| OCR of scans                           | Built in the browser: scanned PDFs and images are recognized locally with Tesseract. Always verify the text before publishing                                                                                       |
| In-app preview                         | PDFs, images, text, Markdown, and <code>.docx</code> can be opened in the documents viewer. <code>.doc</code> is download-only                                                                                      |
| AI classifying issues                  | Not built — keyword suggestions only                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Duplicate file                         | Recorded as <b>duplicate</b> , not as a failure                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Same citation, different scan          | Attached to the <i>existing</i> case as another source file                                                                                                                                                         |

## Publish checklist (Case Law)

The system will refuse to publish placeholder shells. You need a real name, citation, jurisdiction, and deciding court — not "Untitled (pending review)".

Legislation needs a real title, code, and jurisdiction.

## Drafts stay invisible

A magistrate searching Case Law during your review will not stumble on a half-imported fixture. That is intentional.

## Tags

Proposed tags are suggestions. Nothing is applied until you save tags on the review card. Matching is by name so "Hearsay" and "hearsay" do not become two topics.

## Two "courts" again

When you set **deciding court** on a case, you are picking from the *reported authorities* list (CCJ, High Court, ...). You are not picking a Magistrates' Court from the docket roster.

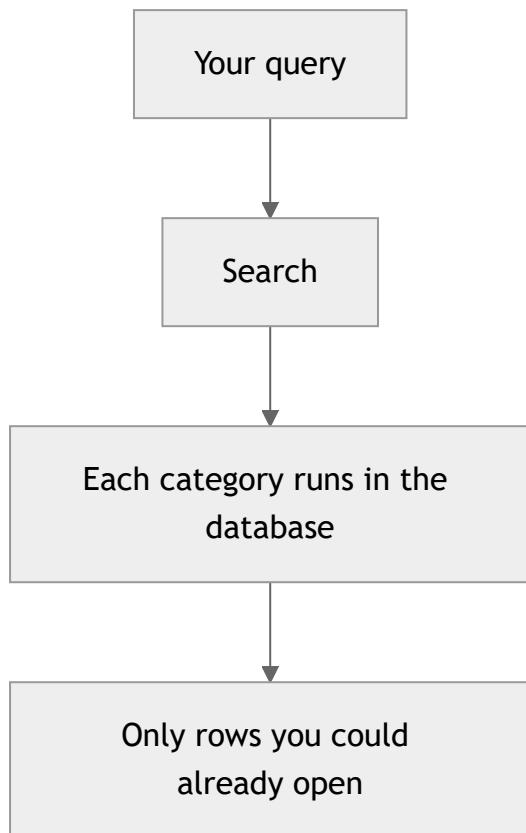
## 10. Search and bookmarks

### Search

Open **Search** and type as you would in a library catalogue.

Results are grouped. Typical groups:

- Docket matters
- Judgments
- Case law
- Legislation (the Act title and summary). A phrase that lives **only** inside a section is more reliably found on the Legislation list page than here.
- Quick codes (yours only)
- Bench notes (yours only)
- Legacy "cases" (old table; not used for new work)



Search cannot be used as a peephole. If a judgment is private, it will not appear for anyone but its author. If a docket is another Court's, it will not appear unless you retained it or it was shared with you. Unpublished library drafts do not appear.

### Bookmarks

Star a record from its page. Open **Bookmarks** to return later.

You can bookmark:

- a docket matter
- a judgment
- a case law card
- a quick code
- a bench note
- an Act
- a **section** of an Act
- a leftover legacy case

You cannot bookmark a raw uploaded PDF as its own thing. Bookmark the matter or judgment it is attached to.

## Dashboard as a shortcut

The Dashboard is a thin "today" view of the same locks: your Courts, coming dates, retained files, your drafts. If it is empty, you are probably not seated yet — you can still search the published library and your own notes.

## If you cannot find something

1. Confirm you are allowed to open it (wrong Court? private judgment? unpublished draft?).
2. Try the specialised list page (Docket, Judgments, Case Law) with its own filters.
3. For a section's wording, search from **Legislation**, not only the global search box.